

Try these...

Try a toy that lights up

Your baby's hand control may be improving rapidly now, and she will want to try to swipe at or grab all kinds of objects that come within reach. Appropriate toys for this stage include any that are easy to grip—and if the toy lights up, it will appear even more attractive to her. See if you can borrow, trade, or buy a toy with colorful elements that light up; she will be intrigued to try to hold and explore it.

Change of face

Now that your baby is enjoying looking at new faces and responding to their smiles and conversation, invite friends and relatives over for coffee to widen her social circle. While they are with you, ask if they want to sing her a favorite song or rhyme to let her hear familiar sounds from someone different.

All change

It may only take seconds for your happy, smiling baby to become fretful and cry, especially if she is overtired or has had too much excitement. Respond by quickly changing the pace. Simply producing a book or turning on some calming music, for example, will help you instantly create a quieter atmosphere and you can then soothe her further with some gentle snuggle time together.

Keep hugging

It's never too early to teach your baby how to give and receive affection. You're already the best role model for her by hugging and kissing her, but this time you give her a hug, say, "You hug me," and see if she can hug you back. If your baby is not a natural hugger, show her gentle affection at a level that she can respond to.